

Illustrative: a crude oil tanker off Port Arthur, Texas

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TRADE FLOW WEEKLY · WEEK 41 · 5 OCT – 11 OCT

Gulf oil flows back as Hormuz pressure jumps and supertanker rates hit records

302	32	6/9
trade-flow signals	critical	lanes active

THE BIG STORY

Gulf barrels are back, Hormuz is not

- Kpler: Middle East crude and condensate exports averaged about 16.5 million bpd in September.
- Standard Chartered: volumes are near pre-war, but Hormuz traffic is still well below normal.
- Supertanker rates hit $82 million, and Asian refiners are ditching US oil.

BY THE NUMBERS

$82m

supertanker rates, as Asian refiners ditch US oil

- Brent holds near $100 as Gulf flows collide with record freight costs
- Kuwait is back to about 2 MMbpd, or 75% of prewar levels
- Qatar has gathered empty LNG tankers in the Gulf ahead of possible extra exports

LANE SCOREBOARD · THIS WEEK VS LAST



This week Last week

Strait of Hormuz	**63**	▲17
Panama Canal	**8**	▲4
Red Sea & Suez Canal	**7**	▼3
Mediterranean, Gibraltar & N. Europe	**5**	▲3

Red pins = critical signals · lines = lanes with signals · index = critical×3 + elevated×2 + watch×1

MARKET BY MARKET

Oil, gas & power 69

Russian oil flows to India plunged to 310,000 bpd, driven by economics more than US tariff threats, per OilPrice.com, while Reliance pushed India's Venezuelan imports to a seven-year high. Russia's seaborne crude exports rose 8% in September to 4.088 million bpd.

Shipping & freight 146

Diversions from the drought-hit Panama Canal lifted Strait of Magellan traffic more than 70%. The canal is extending advance reservations to the Panamax locks for the 2027 dry season. South Korea keeps clean product exports ample, and Russia's product exports hit a three-month high.

Grains & agri 66

USDA raised its US corn and soybean crop estimates (corn fell, soybeans rose) and trimmed red meat output. Black Sea grain exports cratered amid a widening maritime war. Reuters says India-bound sunflower oil cargoes face cancellation, and farmers fear Brazil's soybean cost edge in 2027.

Trade policy & sanctions 16

USTR's Greer hosted G20 trade ministers in Milwaukee. Baltic nations are pushing for an EU ban on Russian grain exports, and Vietnam says it can ease its rare earth export ban. India notified a 5,841-tonne sugar export quota to the EU for 2026-27.

WHAT TO WATCH NEXT WEEK

1

Qatar LNG

Will the empty LNG tankers gathered in the Gulf turn into higher exports through Hormuz?

2

Petro Rabigh

Will Saudi authorities confirm or rule out the reported attack on the complex near Jeddah?

3

Panama Canal

Will drought keep pushing ships to the Strait of Magellan as the canal opens Panamax reservations for the 2027 dry season?

FULL REPORT

Lane scoreboard, every story and what it means for traders, charterers and buyers

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Every signal is pinned on the live trade-flow map — updated each weekday.

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